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Udupi Sri Krishna Matha

Udupi Shri Krishna Temple is a well-known historic Hindu temple dedicated to Krishna and Dvaita Matha located in the city of Udupi in Karnataka, India. The Matha area resembles a living Aashram, a holy place for daily devotion and living. Surrounding the Shri Krishna Temple are several temples namely the Udupi Anantheshwara Temple which is over a thousand years old.[1]

Shri Krishna Temple Udupi	
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Krishna Temple, Udupi	
Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
Deity	Krishna
Location	
Location	Udupi
State	Karnataka
Country	India
Location in Karnataka	
Coordinates	13°19′56″N 74°44′46″E
Architecture	

History

The Krishna Matha was founded by the Vaishnavite saint Madhvacharya in the 13th century. He was the founder of the Dvaita school of Vedanta. It is believed that Madhvacharya found the vigraha of Krishna in a large ball of *gopichandana*.[2] As told by Madhvacharya in his *Tantrasara Sangraha*, the Vigraha was placed initially in the east direction. Due to intense devotion shown by Kanakadasa, the deity is said to have turned Pashchimabhimukha (facing west). All the other Vigrahas in other Ashta Muthas face west as well. Devotees always have darshan of Krishna through the inner window, known as the Navagraha Kindi and the outer window known as the Kanakana Kindi, which is decorated by an arch named after the saint Kanakadasa. A statue has also been erected. A similar window covers the immediate front of the Vigraha and is called Navagraha Kindi. It is often mistaken to be the Kanakana Kindi.[3]

The temple opens at 5:30 hours IST. The unique feature of the temple is that the deity is worshipped through a silver-plated window with nine holes (Navagraha Kindi).[4] The temple also offers prasada at noon and is popularly called *Anna Brahma* as it feeds a vast number of devotees.

Krishna Matha

Type	Kerala architecture
Completed	13th Century

Chariot in front of the Sri Krishna Temple

The daily sevas (offerings to god) and administration of the Krishna Mathas is managed by the Ashta Mathas (eight monasteries). Each of the Ashta Mathas performs temple management activities for two years in a cyclical order. They are collectively known as the 'Ashta Mathagalu' in Kannada. Each Ashta Matha has its own deity which is called *Pattada Devaru.*

The Krishna Matha is known for its religious customs, traditions and tenets of Dvaita or Tatvavada philosophy. It is also the center of Daasa Saahitya, a form of literature that originated in Udupi.

These eight Mathas are:

- Palimaru Matha
- Admaru Matha
- Krishnapura Matha
- Puttige
- Shirur Matha
- Sodhe Matha
- Kaniyoor Matha
- Pejavara

The expenses of Udupi Krishna Matha are borne by the voluntary contributions of the devotees and by the Ashta Mathas that manage the Krishna Matha. The contribution may be in cash or kind. The Krishna Matha, which owned large tracts of land, lost it all in 1975 due to the enactment of the Land Reforms Act 1975 by the Government of Karnataka.

The Pauli of Krishna Matha was renovated and the Brahmakalashotsava ceremony was held on 18 May 2017.[5]

Swamis of the Ashta Mathas

The Swamis of the Ashta Mathas and their successors are as follows.

Matha	Current Swaameejee	Successor or Junior
Pejavara	Shri Vishvaprasanna Teertha Swamiji	
Palimaru	Shri Vidyadeesha Teertha Swamiji	Shri Vidyarajeshwara Teertha Swamiji
Adamaru	Shri Vishvapriya Teertha Swamiji	Shri Eeshapriya Teertha Swamiji
Puttige	Shri Sugunendra Teertha Swamiji	Shri Sushreendra Teertha Swamiji
Sodhe	Shri Vishwavallabha Teertha Swamiji	
Kaniyooru	Shri Vidyavallabha Teertha Swamiji	
Shirur	Shri Vedavardhana Teertha Swamiji	
Krishnapura	Shri Vidyasagara Teertha Swamiji	

Festivals

Sri Krishna Matha during Paryaya festival January 2022

During the Paryaya festival, held once every two years, the temple management is handed over to the next Ashta Matha, which has been entrusted the responsibility of running the temple turn by turn. Each of the Mathas is headed by a swami, who will be in charge of the temple during his Paryaya. The Paryaya is held on even years The Paryaya tradition has completed 500 years as of 2021.[6] Presently, Puttige Matha is administering the temple with Junior Pontiff Shri Sushreendra Teertha Swamiji ascending the post of Sarvajna or Paryaya Peetha. Festivals like Makara Sankranthi, Ratha Sapthami, Madhva Navami, Hanuman Jayanthi, Sri Krishna Janmashtami, Navarathi Mahotsava, Madhva Jayanti, Vijaya Dashami, Naraka Chathurdashi, Deepavali, and Geetha Jayanthi are celebrated by Paryaya Mutt every year.[7]

Gallery

Sri Krishna Matha during Paryaya festival January 2022

Temple painted in yellow-red

Brahma ratha of Udupi Krishna

Goshala at Udupi Sri Krishna Temple

The Chariot at Udupi Sri Krishna Temple

Golden Chariot of Udupi Sri Krishna Temple

Base of Navarathna Chariot

Udupi Sri krishna Temple pond

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External links

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